The Dead Wizards Tower

HOMEBREW

A wizard is dead, but his work lives on.

By J Carmichael

Foreword

Thank you for picking up this one-shot adventure. It has been written so as to be able to slot into any game setting but please feel free to edit and adjust any parts as you need to better fit your campaign, or alternatively run it as a completely separate one shot adventure as a chance to take a little break from your normal game. Or alternatively use it to introduce new players to the game with a simple premise that highlights some of the key elements of a good D&D adventure including combat, puzzle solving and role play.

I have attempted to ensure the adventure can be completed in 1 session of 4 hours and a couple of test runs has proven that this is largely dependent on the familiarity of your players with the game, so be prepared to run a bit longer if introducing new players! However due to the modular nature of this adventure you can realistically make it as long as you like!

As with most pre-written adventures the combat encounters within can swing wildly between barely a challenge to incredibly deadly depending on the party composition so if you find the encounters too difficult or too easy please do adjust them as you go!

Introduction

This is a Tier One adventure module for Dungeons and Dragons 5th Edition. It has been designed for 3-6 Player Characters of 5th Level. This adventure can be run in a single 4-hour session, perfect for convention play, or to fit into an ongoing campaign.

The PCs will discover a magical tower, *Greenstaff Tower*, and be employed by a wizard to delve into its depths to retrieve a spell book.

Background

The owner of the *Greenstaff Tower, Brann "Greenstaff" Kreel* passed away 3 days ago, an old friend and rival, Rollin Blindewoll has since been made aware of this situation and wishes to retrieve the works of his now deceased friend.

Both men were powerful Wizards and friendship amongst wizards often comes with a healthy rivalry. The two would be at each other's throats more often than not.

Greenstaff Tower was Brann's home, study and laboratory and also one of his greatest magical achievements. A marvel of spatial and planar magic, it was created by Brann as a place to carry out his research in safety and solitude. It is also a construction of individual pocket dimensions connected via magic and stored within the tower's outer walls. Each level was constructed for a specific purpose and is very dangerous to unwanted guests.

Brann was obsessed with the study of life in all its forms. Much of his study was dedicated to creating synthetic life via magic. Brann travelled the multiverse and beyond with his magical tower collecting and examining life. The tower became home to all forms of magical life, some creatures of study, some creations of Brann's own creation. It was a stronghold to protect his creations, his samples, his life's work. In his final years, Brann came ever close to creating true sentient life.

Rollins study of the arcane was not dissimilar to Brann's, though he was not quite the genius that the Greenstaff was. Now that Rollins knows of his friends passing, he is desperate to lay his hands on the spellbook and capture the knowledge that he desires. He knows that the tower is a strong fortress, designed to keep others out, as much as to keep Greenstaff's experiments in. So, impregnating the tower will be most challenging.

Adventure Hooks

The tower itself and the magic items within are a literal treasure trove and could provide a suitable motivation for PCs entering the tower. Alternatively, Brann kept a large library with books on many subjects and perhaps there is a piece of information stored within that the party require.

The Greenstaff Tower

The tower itself is created through magic, a specific spell that Brann himself developed. The spell allows the caster to summon the tower to any location they desire and control the layout and shape of its interior. A building such as this would be very highly sought after and could perhaps be rewarded to a party in need of a base of operations.

A Lifetime of collecting

Brann spent much of his life adventuring and he has collected a large selection of magic items useful to any adventuring party. There is always the option to include items you believe would be beneficial to your party but which have not already been included in this adventure. You may also wish to include any important artifacts in your world's lore amongst the treasures of Brann's collection.

A Letter of Importance

A letter detailing Branns death is sent to a member of the party claiming that he is an old relative of theirs. Further it indicates that they should travel to the location indicated to retrieve his belongings and his vasts sums of wealth which has been left to them. Whether or not the party member is actually related to Brann is irrelevant as the letter was written by Rollin Blindewoll in an attempt to get a group of adventurers to come and take on the dangers of the tower for him.

A Powerful Weapon

If the party have a powerful benefactor to whom they answer then perhaps they have been set out to find the Greenstaff Tower, a construction of much rumour which appears to move as it's owner wills. Word has spread that the owner of the tower recently had a major breakthrough in his magical studies and has created something never seen before, something quite powerful that should only be wielded by the right people.

Placing the adventure

The tower in which this adventure is set is designed to fit into any setting. The physical location should be just off of a main road, between two major cities. Simply have the tower appear when the party is traveling to initiate the adventure.

Adventure Summary

The PC's are travelling and discover a magical tower. There they meet Rollin Blindlewoll, a halfling wizard. He sets them on a mission to retrieve the spell book of his dead friend and rival from within the tower.

The PC's enter the tower and find a message left by the towers owner warning them of the trials ahead. They also discover the tower to be much larger on the inside than it appears on the outside.

Moving upwards through the levels the party first enter a storage room full of armour and precious items protected by several animated constructs.

The next floor contains a library decorated with stone grotesques. The door to the next floor is blocked by a puzzle trap consisting of two **gargoyles** and a large hourglass timer.

The third floor contains a large, self-contained forest where the players must battle through an ambush of **blights** and convince a **couatl**, who guards the area,that they mean no harm.

Finally, the PC's will discover the wizard's personal study at the top of the tower. There they encounter a magical door that is opened by solving a series of riddles. This will lead them to the inner sanctum, the final chamber, which contains the sought-after items as well as an unexpected surprise; Brann's last experiment on life, a **spectator** and a **clay golem** named *Lutum*.

Part 1 - The Wizards Tower

A Friend and Rival

The owner of the *Greenstaff Tower*, *Brann "Greenstaff" Kreel*, passed away 3 days ago. An old friend and rival, *Rollin Blindewoll*, was made aware of this situation via the the imp the wizards used to communicate. He has since travelled to the current location of the tower in the hopes of claiming the most precious knowledge from within the tower, the Greenstaff itself, and the spellbook. As there was an intense rivalry between the two friends, Rollin knows that taking the items will not be an easy task, for *Greenstaff* was as cunning as he was brilliant.

As the PC's arrive Blindlewoll sees this as an excellent opportunity to probe into the tower without exposing himself to any danger. In explaining the situation to the PC's, he will focus heavily on his friendship with Brann and will attempt to conceal their rivalry. He also wil play down the displeasure Brann would have experienced knowing his old rival was attempting to steal his life's work. Blindlewoll will commissions the party to enter the tower on his behalf and retrieve Brann's spell book and his staff.

If the party are to gain control to the tower after the adventure this could be part of Blindlewoll's offer.

Once an arrangement has been agreed, Blindlewoll will grant the PC's entry to the tower and wish them luck. The PC's will discover that the towers outer dimensions do not translate to it's inner dimensions. This is due to the fact that the tower itself is actually a construction of several pocket dimensions linked to one another with the appearance of a tower.

What he knows - Blindlewoll knows that Brann has spent his lifetime studying life in its purist forms in the hopes of creating real, sentient life with magic. This is unlike much of the other forms of magical life found throughout the planes, which is unintelligent.

He also knows that Brann will have set traps and tests in order to prevent people from reaching his prized possessions making the journey through the tower particularly deadly. While he does not know the exact nature of said traps, or even what creatures they are likely to encounter, he does know that Brann was a good man and therefore expects the trials within to be a fair challenge.

He also knows that the towers magic is tied to Brann's staff and that to make use of the tower you need both his spell book and his staff.

What he wants - - Blindlewoll wants Brann's works, spell book and staff. If however, the PC's are to gain control of the tower as part of this adventure, the spell book and staff could be offered as reward as opposed to monetary gain. Since Blindlewoll is a wizard, he may want to copy the spells into his own spellbook and create his own tower.

Finding the Tower

As the players are moving between adventures they will stumble upon a tower, previously hidden by magic, which appears once they are within 100 feet of it. The tower seemingly pops into existence just off of the side of the road. It is some 60 feet tall and 30 feet wide. The topmost section of the tower appears to be simple brickwork with the lower portion partially hidden behind large stones, as if the tower has pushed itself up through the earth.

A short path winds through the upheaved earth to a plain wooden door, in front of which is a stout halfling in wizards robes. When the party appears within sight he jumps in surprise and beckons them close to offer a job.

> "Ah, adventurers! Just what I was in need of! I wonder could you help me, my name is Rollin Bindlewoll, a wizard as you may have guessed. This tower belongs to my dear, dear friend Brann "Greenstaff" Kreel. Unfortunately I received word that he passed away some time in the past few days while carrying out research in his tower. My problem is that he was a very careful man and has left his towers defences activated. This means I cannot retrieve his work without posing some danger to myself.
>
> Now, if you would be willing to accept payment, say 500 gold a head, I'd be more than willing to contract you to enter his tower and retrieve his works from the study at the top. Does this sound amenable? I have the ability to open the door; I would just rather not risk my own skin.

While most of what Blindlewoll says is true, if the party wish to, they can perform a Wisdom (Insight) Check DC 15, if successful they can sense that what he says about Brann dying is true, but there is more to their friendship than he is letting on.

If the party push Blindlewoll for more information they can make a Charisma (Persuasion) Check DC 12, on a success he will reveal the following if questioned:

Learning of his Death - If the party ask Rollin how he learned of Brann's death he will respond: "Oh, we would often communicate via familiar or infernal messenger, one of these creatures let me know of his untimely passing."

Inside the Tower - If the party ask more of what to expect within the tower he will respond:

"Well firstly you should know that the inside is some size larger than the outside, extra dimensional planes and all that... Brann himself was also a bit of a collector, he was interested in life and kept many things in which to study its effects, animals, plants... Items.... You'll likely find many of these inside, as well as his library of course.

If the party wish to haggle, they can make a Charisma (Persuasion) Check DC 15 and Blindlewoll will increase the reward money up to 1000gp a head if they succeed.

If the party come to an agreement then Blindlewoll will step up to the door, place the head of his staff against it and mutter an incantation. There will be a brilliant flash followed by a click and the door will begin to swing inward.

Entering the Tower

Brann "Greenstaff" Kreel

The owner of the tower, in anticipation of his death, has left a warning in the form of an illusion which will activated when someone enters the tower. It will relay a message he has recorded directed at Blindlewoll or whichever unlucky adventurers have taken up a contract with him.

Brann was not an evil man, in fact in life he was very kind but driven by his studies. He does not wish to see his work fall into hands that would put it to ill use and has therefore set traps and challenges throughout his tower so that only those he thinks would be worthy would be able to make use of what he has discovered.

The Ground Floor

The ground floor of Greenstaff tower is of circular construction, 200 feet across, and made of old worn flagstones, this is only of note because the tower appears to be no more than 60 feet in diameter from the outside.

20 feet to either side of the entrance are great staircases which follow the walls around the periphery of the room and meet at a point hidden behind a wall opposite and some 100 feet above the entrance.

In the very centre of the room stands a large purple crystal, over 6 feet tall, held upright in a silver frame. The room is empty apart from this.

The doors swing inward to reveal a room more than twice the size of the tower which appears to encompass it, an atrium of aged stone lit by great burning torches which hang from the walls.

Directly opposite the entrance, in the centre of the floor sits a purple crystal, about the size of a man, held upright in a silver frame. Once the door closes a light shines from its centre and flashes upward taking on the wizened face of an old human man.

A permanent scowl twists what little of his face is visible beneath the bushy beard and thick dangling eyebrows. The image begins to speak and a rasping voice echoes around the chamber.

"Blindlewoll! I know that's you, you conniving little sneak! Unless of course you've paid some dim-witted adventurers to do your dirty work for you! Yes, that's more your speed isn't it?

Well, I know why you're here! I'm sure my slippers are barely cold but you've come for my research, a lifetime of work! MY work! Well you can have it... If you can get it! Good luck you little wretch!"

The image cackles madly before cutting off and vanishing back into the crystal.

Once the image disappears the party are free to move further into the tower. The crystal it-self is too large or heavy to be moved easily and if the party were to attempt to remove it and take it outside Blindlewoll would admonish them indicated that he asked for their help not for them to ransack the tower.

There is nothing else of interest in this room and the party should be encouraged to take either staircase to the next level.

Part 2 – The Lower Levels

First Floor: The Depository

At the top of the staircases is a thick wooden door. It is closed but unlocked. On the other side is a storage area measuring 80ft square. Here the Wizard Brann kept different adventuring supplies he had collected over the years. There are stands of non-magical armour and weapons, chests full of clothes in varying designs and equipment for travelling including bed rolls, cooking gear, lamps and oils.

> This room was clearly used for storage and contains a lifetimes worth of items collected through adventuring.
>
> Chests line the walls of the room and shelves and stands are spaced periodically throughout it. Several sets of armour are displayed on their own individual stands and weapons in varying styles and sizes are displayed in cases and on the walls.

To protect the tower from intruders the room is home to two **Animated Armours**, two **Flying Swords**, a **Rug of Smothering** and a **Mimic** in the form of a chest, their locations are marked on the map overleaf. The mimic will not react unless a PC touches it, whereas the other creatures will spring to life as soon as a PC interacts with anything except the mimic.

The **Animated Armours** flank the entrance to the room preventing intruders from leaving.

The **Flying Swords** are mounted at the far end on either side of the door leading further into the tower.

The **Rug of Smothering** sits in the centre of the room.

The **Mimic** is on one side of the room against the wall roughly halfway along.

Once the rooms defenses have been activated the rug will attack whoever steps on it the moment they do so. If the rooms defenses have not been activated the rug does not move to attack.

Treasure - Most of the chests and cabinets are open and able to be searched through revealing mostly mundane items, players can find any basic piece of equipment in their desired size.

There are 3 chests however which are magically locked, they can only be opened with the Knock spell or a Strength (Athletics) check DC 20, inside the players can find 10pp, 500gp, 2 potions of healing and a Book of Riddles. These chests are the first, third and fifth one on the wall opposite the mimic.

On the far side of the room the door opens onto another set of stairs which split, following the circumference of the tower in opposite directions.

Book of Riddles

Keep note if the party discover the book of riddles. When they reach Branns Study on the fourth floor they can perform an Intelligence (Investigation) check, DC15, with this book to discover the answers to the riddles instead of working the them out themselves.

Second Floor: The Library

After following the stairs up and around the party will find another set of doors which lead to a large library. The room is 200 feet square but the gloom makes it appear larger. There are shadows obscuring the ceiling. The room is filled with many bookcases containing books on any conceivable subject.

> The room is full, wall to wall, with shelf after shelf of books. The shelves themselves are all different in size and design, some being simple wood with little ornamentation, others appearing to be chiselled from stone. Some are barely as tall as a man and others stretch far above, beyond the reach of the torch light which warms the room. As well as the shelves the room is dotted with statues. Crouched upon some of the shelves are motionless grotesques.

There is a cleared central path which leads across the length of the room, at the far end there is an area cleared of shelves 60 feet square. In the centre of this area, directly opposite the door leading out, is an ornate crystal hourglass on a pedestal flanked by two monstrous statues (**Gargoyles**).

If the party decide to investigate the books shelves, they will find a book on Elemental Creatures with some hand written notes which read as follows;

> These creatures astound me, beings of earth, fire, air and water, all conscious, all living. Life in its most pure form. I must find a way to replicate their creation.

The book on Elemental Creatures grants the wielder advantage on any Nature checks made on elemental type creatures.

Treasure - A PC may perform an Intelligence (Investigation) check DC 16, each party member can do this only once, on a success they find one spell scroll, roll 1d6 and consult the following table to determine which scroll they find:

Spell Scroll

	Spell
1	Mage Hand
2	Shield
3	Detect Magic
4	Sleep
5	Invisibility
6	Re-roll

Once a PC steps into the cleared area the hourglass magically turns over and counts down, draining sand. The two **Gargoyles** animate and defend the hourglass.

> As you step past the bookshelves at the perimeter of the cleared area the hourglass moves of its own accord, flipping itself so that sand begins to fall from one bulb to the other. As soon as the hissing of the sand reaches your ears you hear another, more ominous sound, as the two grotesque statues creak and crack as they begin to move. They bellow a guttural, gravely roar and rush forward with their clawed, stone-like hands raised to attack you.

The Timer Trap

The timer will count down 30 seconds (5 rounds of combat), if a player wants to know exactly how long the timer will take they must roll an Intelligence (Investigation) check DC 14 within 30 feet of the pedestal, on a success they learn the remaining duration of the hourglass, otherwise they only get a vague sense of the time.

The door leaving the room is magically locked and sealed and will remain locked until all of the sand is contained within a single bulb of the hourglass (a knock spell will have no effect on the door), at which point it will audibly click and become unlocked.

The hourglass' bulbs can be moved by the PC's in any way, even flipped back over, but the door will not open until all of the sand is in one bulb. The hourglass however is impervious to damage, both physical and magical and the frame is fixed firmly to the pedestal.

The **gargoyles** will attempt to stop the players from touching the hourglass, they will not chase them out of the cleared area but will attack them while they remain within it. The **gargoyles** will also return to their statue forms once the timer runs out and will no longer be hostile to the players.

If the gargoyles are defeated before the timer runs out then one more will arrive from the outer regions of the room after 2 rounds has passed, if these extra **gargoyles** are defeated while the timer remains active then more will takes their place after 2 rounds, combat continues in this way until the hourglass runs out.

Part 3 - The Upper Levels

Third Floor

The Arboretum

This floor was used by Brann to study living creatures who show some form of sentience, to that end he has created a living forest that fills the entire floor, 500 feet square. A single path winds its way through the forest from one end of the room to the other with a large clearing in the centre of the room. Besides the trees the room also contains a number of small creatures like rabbits and foxes in order to create a living ecosystem.

> In stark contrast to the previous floors this one opens into what appears to be a lush and verdant forest, you can hear insects buzzing around you and birds singing from the tops of the tall trees. A path cuts through the forest before you as what appears to be sunlight streams through the canopy above.

A successful Intelligence (Arcana) check DC 12 will determine that the sunlight is magical in nature, possibly an enchantment making use of the Sunlight spell allowing the trees to grow naturally.

In the clearing at the centre of the room is a lean to shack containing botanist equipment and alchemical supplies. If the party get close to the table at any point, they will find several hand written notes detailing Brann's study of sentient plant life and his desire to find its origins.

> "The origins of the Blights is a horrific one. Born of the tree which grew from the stake plunged through the heart powerful vampire. They are evil from their conception, though luckily not particularly intelligent. They are however adept at ambushing the unwary."

When the PCs enter the clearing, they will be ambushed by an assortment of blights, 4 **Needle Blights**, 6 **Twig Blights** and 2 **Vine Blights**, they will attack all members of the party without hesitation.

If the party attempt to check for hostiles before entering the clearing they can make a Wisdom (Perception) check DC 14, on a success they become aware of the presence of the various Blights. If they fail the check or do not look before entering the clearing, the **Blights** will get a surprise round unless any member of the party has a Passive Perception of 16 or higher.

The Gardener

Once all of the **Blights** have been defeated a **Couatl** will approach the PCs. He takes the form of a human dressed as a gardener. The couatl is not hostile, however it is tasked with protecting the tower and tending to Brann's forest. It will introduce itself as Ichtacka and if the players can convince it that they are there to retrieve the wizards spell books after his death it will allow them to pass. As they leave the clearing the party can make a Wisdom (Perception) check DC 15, on a success they will see the man shift into his true form before flying away on silent wings. Should the party become aggressive however, or allude to looting the tower, the Couatl will immediately shift into its true form and attack. Alternatively, the Couatl could become aggressive to any PC with an evil alignment.

As per the Couatl's Truth Tellers ability, it cannot lie, but whilst in it's human form it will attempt to mislead the party, answering questions vaguely with little detail.

> As you slay the last of the Blights a small human man dressed in green overalls with a belt of gardening tools slung over his hips, steps from the cover of the foliage, his skin like weathered mahogany with thick dark hair hanging in light curls. He steps gingerly over the remains of the Blights and approaches you, asking if everyone is all right.

Once the party have finished their interaction with the Couatl they can follow the path on from the clearing until they reach the door leading to the next floor.

Fourth Floor

The Study

This room appears to be a combination of bedroom and study, it is 40 feet square with each wall following a cardinal direction with the entry way in the Southern Wall.

Western Wall

Against the Western wall stands a large four-poster bed, it looks as though it has been slept in recently as it's drapes are partially pulled back revealing a rumpled set of sheets. There is a night stand on which rests a silver pitcher and basin apparently used for freshening up. The pitcher appears to be magically enchanted to keep its contents chilled. There is also a full-length mirror next to a wardrobe full of wizard's robes.

Northern Wall

On the Northern wall, opposite the door, sits a large ornate desk with several open books, quills, inks and shards of a crystal wand blasted across the surface. A successful Intelligence (Arcana) check DC 12 and the PC knows that this is a destroyed arcane focus.

Eastern Wall

At the centre of the Eastern wall sits a large and spacious fire place almost 6 feet tall with ash and dust resting in its grate. In front of it sits a large wing-back chair that upon initial inspection appears incredibly comfortable and relaxing.

Southern Wall

In the corner to the left of the entrance sits a small piano and a harp, both exquisitely decorated with gold and silver filigree. Both appear to be well kept but showing wear from use. Sheet music rests in a disorderly pile atop the piano.

Along the wall to the right of the entrance sits a bookshelf and a display shelf featuring various trinkets and ornaments. The bookshelf seems to mostly contain old journals and notebooks with a few reference books showing years of wear and tear. The display shelf hosts a variety of oddities with little in common with one another, from small shards of gems to a few strange coins with unrecognizable castings.

> It is apparent as soon as you enter that this room is one that has been lived in, the evidence of a life well lived can be found all throughout, and while there is little of monetary value there is much of sentimental value.

If the party search the room, they can discover that the books they were sent to find are not present here, however one of the open books on the desk is the latest journal of Brann "Greenstaff" Kreel. His latest entry reads:

> "I fear my time on this plane draws towards its end, I have dedicated my life to my research and study and I'll be damned if it will fall into the hands of one unworthy to wield it. I have gone over my protective spells and trials for any would be "rescuer" of my work in an attempt to ensure it only falls into the hands of one who deserves it, I can do little else at this point. My greatest works, my collection of spells and incantations will be locked away before I go to my final rest.
>
> If you are reading this after my passing then you have done well to reach this point, perhaps you are worthy of my work, but there is still more you must do, I wish you well.
>
> Brann "Greenstaff" Kreel."

An Intelligence (Investigation) Check DC 15 reveals that this is probably the last place the wizard was before dying and that his passing couldn't have been more than a few days ago.

If the party wish they can spend some time reading the journal, it features personal musings from Brann as opposed to notes on his research and study. It paints the image of a fastidious and intelligent man who has dedicated his life to his studies.

The Fireplace

Many Keys

If any of the players moves within 5 feet of the fireplace a message appears on its surface.

> As you approach the fireplace a flame springs up in its grate bathing the room in a warm glow, an illusory script appears and dances along the mantle reading:
>
> "Though with many keys I am adorned, there is no locked portal I can unbar."

This is a riddle the party must answer; the only way to answer it is to play something on the piano, anything at all. Saying the answer out loud has no effect. If they touch anything other than the piano then the fire in the hearth will explode outward, each player must make a Dexterity Saving Throw DC 15 or take 1d6 fire damage. The flames do no damage to anything else in the room, this happens for each riddle that appears.

Of the Many Things I Own

Once the party get the correct answer the script changes.

> As the last note dies away the script on the mantle shifts and shimmers until it reads as follows:
>
> "Of the many things I own there is one thing I alone posses and yet others use it much more than I."

The answer to this riddle is the name of the Wizard who owns the tower, Brann "Greenstaff" Kreel, a player must this time say his name out aloud while their hand rests on the latest journal of Brann located on his desk.

I Alone

Again, when the answer is given the script changes once more.

> "I alone may enter here, though sometimes there is one beside me."

This time the answer is the mirror, if a party member stands in front of it with the fireplace to their back and touches it then it will react.

> The surface of the mirror ripples at your touch and shimmers slightly. As you peer into the reflection you notice the wall at the back of the fireplace fades away to nothing but as you turn away to look behind you it appears as solid as ever.

In the room the fireplace still appears to be solid but if a player investigates it, they will discover it is an illusion and that the fire, though warm, will cause them no harm.

If the players struggle with any of these riddles they can perform another investigation of the room, each time being reminded of its contents, if they still struggle to come up with an answer, they can make a relevant skill check to gain hints towards the correct answer. If any player uses detect magic then the items used to solve each riddle will glow, as will the fireplace, the pitcher and several of the ornaments and pieces of the arcane focus on the desk. The items related to the riddles show Transmutation magic, the pitcher and arcane focus shows Evocation, the fireplace shows a combination of Illusion, Conjuration and Abjuration, and the ornaments on the shelf show a random selection from each of the schools with no particular school showing dominance.

Once the party have revealed the illusory wall at the rear of the fireplace, they can travel through it to the hidden sanctum.

The Sanctum

This hidden sanctum was where Brann kept his most prized possessions, his spell book, his staff and the culmination of his studies. The room also contains his greatest creation, the clay golem *Lutum*.

Ever cautious Brann had entered into an agreement with a **Spectator** using it as a last line of defence for his treasures.

Lutum

Clay golems are usually nothing more than vessels for a spirit summoned from the Elemental Plane of Earth and bound to do the biding of their summoner, *Lutum* however is different.

He is in fact the result of Brann's study of life, or more accurately, he contains the results of those studies. For *Lutum* is no mere elemental spirit, he is instead a life created solely through magic, a sentient soul. He is alive.

Lutum has a childlike demeanour, he calls out for his father when anyone tries to talk to him. If *Lutum* is conversed with, he will admit that his father ordered him to remain within the sanctum and not leave until he returns. Should any of the PCs attempt to make Lutum leave the room he will refuse and eventually become violent if pushed too far. Should he learn of Brann's death he will become incredibly distraught wailing for some time before violently lashing out at the PCs and begging them to leave him alone.

Lutum will not prevent the player characters from removing any of the other items from the room.

Contracted Help

While you would be very hard pressed to recruit a **beholder** into your service there is always the option of hiring a **spectator**. What they lack in power they make up for in sheer insanity, but they certainly make for a powerful deterrent, especially to those adventurers who don't know the difference.

Brann has contracted one such **spectator** into his service to protect his prized possessions. This spectator, like most of its ilk, is quite insane, but will do the job it was contracted to do. Unless of course it learns of Brann's death.

This **spectator** does not have a name and if the player characters converse with it, which it will do freely, it will pick whichever of their names it likes the most and refer to itself with that name from then on. It will also insult any other name which it finds inferior. Should the player characters spend any length of time conversing with it then the conversation will swiftly devolve into bickering about something unimportant. It will only become hostile to the player characters if they attempt to take any of the items on the table. If it learns of Brann's death it will then claim the tower and contents for itself but will remain friendly to the player characters until they attempt to take the items or disagree with it in any way, at which point it will attack, screaming at them to leave.

What he knows about Lutum - The **spectator** knows little of Brann's magic but he is aware that the focus of his work was on creating life, not summoning it from another plane but creating it with just magic. *Lutum* was the result of this study.

The **spectator** will not reveal any of this quickly as it finds the topic boring, but it can be coaxed into revealing this information over time.

The room itself is of circular construction 50 feet in diameter, the floor and walls are bare flagstone and the ceiling is hidden far above in gloom.

> You step through the fireplace into a dark room, the flames from the fire behind you throwing your shadow out into the space before you, before your eyes can adjust several torches flicker to life on the walls to either side of you illuminating a circular room of bare stone, at its centre sits a large solid looking wooden table with several books and a tall wooden staff resting on it.
>
> In front of the table floats a strange creature with one large eye and several smaller ones on shifting stalks about its spherical body, each one now focused on you. Behind them towers a humanoid shape constructed from some sort of rough clay, its features seem simple and almost unfinished as it stares directly ahead.

The creatures inhabiting it are a **Spectator** and a **Clay Golem** named *Lutum* under the command of the now dead wizard. See the adjusted stats for *Lutum* below.

The spectator will freely converse with the players, letting them know that it is bound to serve the wizard who owns the tower and to protect his spell books on the table. They will occasionally talk to themselves and devolve into bickering with itself quickly unless they are continuously prompted to converse.

If the **spectator** is provoked it will follow the players out of the sanctum should they attempt to flee in order to kill them.

The players can attempt the converse with the golem, either before or during combat, it will be slow to respond and speak in a childlike manner asking after its "father" and where he is. So long as the players do not mention the wizard's death the golem will converse freely, though it will appear shy and not have much information to give other than its name, Lutum, that it was "created by father" and that it must "stay here until father comes back". If the players tell it that the wizard is dead it will wail "Where is father!?" before attacking the players in a blind rage, it will take 2 successful Persuasion checks, DC 18, in a row in order to calm it down again. It will not leave the room it is in and will halt its assault if the players move back into the study.

If the players engage in combat with the **spectator** but have not provoked *Lutum* he will cower away from battle and wail for "his father".

Treasure - If the party defeat the **spectator** they are free to take the books and the staff, if they do so they will feel a slight tremor run through the tower under their feet but nothing else will happen. There are 3 books on the table, each of a similar design, one is a compendium of research focusing on the effects of magic on wildlife specifically how it affects life and sentience. One includes research into magical foci and their construction and the last is Brann's spell book, the contents of which can be found at the end of this adventure under Brann's Spell book.

The staff is 6 feet long and made of what appears to be a uniformly thick tree branch with a faintly glowing crystal at its tip. This staff has the following features:

The Greenstaff

Staff, very rare (requires attunement by a sorceror, warlock or wizard)

This staff can be wielded as a magic quarterstaff that grants +1 bonus to attack rolls made with it. While you hold it, you gain a +1 bonus to spell attack rolls and a +1 bonus to your spell save DC.

This staff has 15 charges, regaining 1d6 + 2 expended charges daily at dawn. If you expend it's last charge roll a d20. On a 1, the staff glows a vibrant green before exploding with branches and leaves instantly becoming nothing more than a broken tree branch losing all of its magical effects.

Spells While holding this staff, you can use an action to expend some of it's charges to cast the following spells from it, using your spell save DC: *spike growth* (2 charges), *plant growth* (3 charges), *grasping vine* (4 charges), *wall of thorns* (6 charges).

Greenstaffs Tower While holding the staff you can also cast the spell *Greenstaffs Tower* which is detailed in full at the end of this adventure.

The spell Greenstaff Tower is a homebrew spell created for this adventure, it's details can be found on page 14. If you determine that the spell would not fit in your world feel free to omit it from the spells available in the spell book.

Epilogue

Return to Blindlewoll

Once the PCs decide to exit the tower they can move back through to the study, but when they open the door that should lead down to the level below, they will find it opens to the exterior of the tower where they find Rollin sat reading a book.

> "Oh, you're back! I wasn't expecting you to return so quickly! Excellent, excellent... Did you manage to retrieve the items?"

Rollin's reaction will be dependent on what the players did in the Sanctum, if the players are going to receive the Tower as part of their reward then Rollin will take what was promised, as well as Lutum if he was spared, and teleport home. If they were not set to receive the Tower then once the players have handed over the promised items, he will enter the tower before it vanishes.

The following are the mostly likely outcomes for the adventure and what would follow.

Benevolence

If the players have defeated the **spectator** but spared *Lutum* then Rollin will be ecstatic to learn of his existence and will ask many questions about what the players have learnt so far about his existence before crying tears of joy that his late friend Brann had managed to complete his work. He will offer to look after *Lutum* and continue to raise him, he will also offer the player characters his assistance in the future as an extra reward.

Death of an Innocent

Should the player characters have killed both the **spectator** and *Lutum* Rollins reaction will be dependent on whether or not the players reveal the existence of Lutum or whether they have worked out enough about the creature to determine that it was more than a regular clay golem, either way Rolling will be perplexed by its existence and frustrated with the player characters for killing it before it could be fully examined as he is sure it must have been relevant to Brann's studies.

Finder Keepers

If the party decide to renege on their agreement with Rollin and keep all of the items they found within the tower Rollin will not immediately retaliate against the party but will instead vow to pay them back for their betrayal in the future.

This leaves the option to turn Rollin into a recurring character who will return at some point in the future to seek revenge against the party.

Lutum

Medium Construct, lawful neutral

Armor Class 14
Hit Points 93(11d8 + 44)
Speed 20ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	9 (-1)	18 (+4)	9 (-1)	10 (+0)	8 (-1)

Damage Immunities acid, poison
Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing and slashing from nonmagical weapons
Condition Immunities exhaustion, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned
Senses darkvision, passive Perception 10
Languages common, elvish, dwarvish, gnomish, orcish, draconic
Challenge 5 (1,800 XP)

Acid Absorption. Whenever the golem is subjected to acid damage, it takes no damage and instead regains a number of hit points equal to the acid damage dealt.

Pitiful Appearance When Lutum starts its turn with 45 hit points or fewer it begins to wail. The sound is so reminiscent of a child's that all creatures who attempt to target it with an attack or spell must first make a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw, on a failed save the creature fails to carry out its action. Once a creature has succeeded on this save it is immune to its effects for 24 hours.

Immutable Form. Lutum is immune to any spell or effect that would alter its form.

Magic Resistance. The golem has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Magic Weapons. Lutum's weapon attacks are magical.

Actions

Multiattack. Lutum makes two slam attacks.

Slam. Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: (1d10 + 4) bludgeoning damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or have its hit point maximum reduced by an amount equal to half of the damage taken. The target dies if this attack reduces its hit point maximum to 0. The reduction lasts until the target has completed a long rest.

Haste (Recharge 5-6). Until the end of its next turn, Lutum magically gains a +2 bonus to its AC, has advantage on Dexterity saving throws, and can use its slam attack as a bonus action.

Branns Spellbook

If a spellcaster studies *Branns Spellbook* like they would any other then they have the opportunity to copy the following spells into their own spellbook for future use, the normal rules for copying spells still apply:

Cantrips (0 Level)

Blade Ward
Dancing Lights
Light
Mage Hand
Mending
Poison Spray

1st level

Colour Spray
Comprehend Languages
Detect Magic
False Life
Fog Cloud
Ray of Sickness
Sleep

2nd Level

Alter Self
Arcane Lock
Darkvision
Enlarge/ Reduce
Gentle Repose
Gust of Wind
Spider Climb

3rd Level

Animate Dead
Dispell Magic
Feign Death
Protection from Energy
Sending
Water Breathing

4th Level

Banishment
Conjure Minor Elementals
Dimension Door
Fabricate
Locate Creature
Mordenkainens Private Sanctum

5th Level

Animate Objects
Conjure Elemental
Contact Other PLane
Creation
Planar Binding

6th Level

Arcane Gate
Create Undead
Drawmij's Instant Summons
Greenstaff Tower
Sunbeam

7th Level

Mordenkainen's Magnificent Mansion
Plane Shift
Simulacrum

8th Level

Control Weather
Demiplane

Greenstaff Tower

6th-level Conjuration (ritual)

Casting Time: 1 hour
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S, M (the *Greenstaff*)
Duration: Instantaneous

You summon the Greenstaff Tower to a point you designate within 60 feet of you provided it has 60 feet diameter of clear space and fairly even ground, if these prerequisites are not met the spell fails. The tower contains an indeterminate amount of extra dimensional space which you can choose to fill with up to 4 floors of your choice from the following list,

1	Room of Storage
2	Library
3	Arboretum
4	Menagerie
5	Study

While the tower is summoned you can choose to cast the spell again in order to create a new room, the room must be no larger than a 300 foot wide cube and will be empty until you fill it by hand, anything you place in the room will remain in it after it has been dismissed and re-summoned. While dismissed the rooms air remains breathable but only contains whatever food and water were present when it was dismissed. Any room created this way is a bare stone construction whose walls are impervious to damage. You may only have 4 rooms present at any one time, should you create a new room with 4 already present one must be dismissed.

As an action the summoner can choose to dismiss the tower sending it to its own pocket dimension, the summoner can choose to force any creatures present within the tower to appear in the Material plane at the point it was standing or allow them to remain in the tower until it is re-summoned. Creatures forced to vacate will find themselves standing on the cleared ground unharmed.

Designer Notes

The setting for this adventure can be placed anywhere as the tower featured in the story is magically enchanted to appear wherever its owner needed it to be, the ability to control this feature of the tower is locked away in a spell book which is part of the inventory the players are tasked with retrieving, so should this tower be introduced into a long-term campaign it can reappear at opportune moments.

Thank you

Thank you for taking the time to read through this one shot, even if you haven't decided to run it I hope that it at least gave you some ideas to use in your own game.

If you have any feedback then please send it to me at modifiedroll@gmail.com with the Subject Heading "The Dead Wizards Tower".

And while you're here, if you are into D&D actual play podcasts can I suggest giving Modified Roll a listen, we run 5e in a homebrew open world setting!

You can also find us on Twitter, we are @ModifiedRoll

Thank you again!

Credits

Written by Jordan Carmichael of the Modified Roll Podcast
A huge thank you to;

Daniel Matthews who created the wonderful art for the Greenstaff Tower, Crystal Hourglass and The Greenstaff. You can find his work on his website or you can hear him as Baron DeBauche on the Backwater Bastards Podcast

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All other art and assets are taken from the DMsGuild Creator Resource packs or the Homebrewery.

Credit to GM Binder

After initially developing this adventure with Homebrewery I eventually moved it over to GMBinder and it has been a fantastic help in getting the layout and look just right. Greatly appreciate the work they have put into this tool.

The Legal Bit

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